MF MOHAMMED FILALI · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

Consumer Psychology Worksheet

CAMPAIGN PLANNING GUIDE & CREATIVE DIAGNOSIS

Prepared for **Richard Norris**
Project 1%, the 35-Day Foundation
October 2026

BEFORE YOU READ

The short answer

The question behind this worksheet: were the 13 live Project 1% ads built from a psychology plan, or made first and planned later? Each section answers one part of the plan, sets what it should be, and checks the live ads against it.

VERDICT

Strong instincts and a strong founder story, but no plan connecting them. Every ad tries to do the whole journey at once, so no ad does any one job well.

What the evidence shows

1. **Every ad targets the same awareness level, then runs the whole funnel.** 10 of 13 hooks speak to men who already feel the problem. Then each ad races through credentials, mechanism, offer and guarantee. No ad is built to reframe the problem, prove the method, or close the sale.
2. **The test can't tell you which message works.** All 13 ads share the same headline and the same 600-word caption. Only the video changes.
3. **The most-delivered ad is the full 25-minute sales video, shown to cold audiences.** That's a closing asset used as an opener.
4. **The emotional driver is off-target.** The caption opens on a "$200,000 Porsche 911 Turbo" and closes on "the Rolex". It sells status objects to men whose pain is that status objects didn't work. The drivers the research points to (protecting loved ones, freedom from pain and fear, belonging) are mentioned once or twice and never lead.
5. **Some persuasion principles are breaking trust.** Scarcity changes at every step. The price anchor jumps from "under $97" to a "$5,626 value" for $9. A free gift is promised in the video and never delivered.

What's already working (keep it)

- **Richard's true story is the strongest asset in the account:** the slipped discs, the floor of the apartment in 2025, the relationship he lost. It's the "pratfall effect" (see section 3) waiting to lead.
- **Strong individual hooks:** "Most men upgrade the car, the income, the title. Never the operating system" (ad #6), and "This is specifically for men already winning on paper" (ads #4 and #10).
- **Ad #9, "Stop fixing one pillar"**, is the closest to on-strategy: honest, vulnerable, and no confusing price line.
- **Format variety is already there:** talking head, kinetic text, whiteboard, motion graphics.

Sources

All 13 active Meta ads (scripts transcribed, 10–11 Oct 2026). The live funnel at go.richard-norris.com (page, form, checkout, confirmation), and the full 24:50 sales video. 36 public forum posts from business owners (Reddit, BiggerPockets, Fastlane, Bogleheads; 2021–2026) and 35 Blind threads from salaried professionals. Persona and positioning documents prepared alongside this worksheet.

How to read the pages

PRIMARY lead with this · SECONDARY support with this · NOT USED deliberately left out

■ **Current ads** what the live ads do today · ■ **Recommendation** what to change

SECTION 1

Audience Awareness Assessment

Where does the target man sit on Eugene Schwartz's awareness spectrum? The target is the self-made builder of 32–48 who has compounded his money and depreciated himself.

Unaware SMALL SHARE

Doesn't know he has a problem.

A few men still read their exhaustion as "just a busy season". They're reached by pattern interrupts, not pitches.

Problem aware PRIMARY

Knows the problem, not the solution.

Most of the market. He feels the symptoms: burnout, fog, emptiness, absence at home, the weight of every decision alone.

Solution aware SECONDARY

Knows solutions exist, not this one.

He has already tried the usual fixes: hire more people, take a break, sell the business, read *The E-Myth*, a 75-day challenge, therapy, testosterone.

Product aware SECONDARY

Knows the product, hasn't bought.

Richard's warm audience (property clients, YouTube, email) knows *Richard* but not Project 1%. It's small, but it trusts him most.

Most aware RETARGETING ONLY

Ready to buy with the right offer.

Men who watched the video, visited the page or started checkout. This is where the $9 bet belongs.

Market sophistication: high

"Balance", "have it all", "1%", "brotherhood" and "challenge" are claims he has heard many times. Schwartz's answer for a market like this: **reframe the problem** and show a **unique mechanism**.

What the research shows

He's aware of the **symptoms** but misdiagnoses the **cause**. He treats it as an operations problem (hire, delegate, sell, take a break) or a willpower problem (grind harder, another challenge).

> *"Should I sell and move on or get fat off the profit and hate life??"*
> Business owner, 20+ years in the industry, Florida

> *"I feel like this might just be an escape fantasy."*
> Manufacturing owner

> *"It's not the hours I work, but that I can't be present with my family when I'm not working."*
> Entrepreneur, 35, married with a baby

> *"Hours were never my problem. The thing that wrecked me was carrying every open decision in my head all weekend."*
> Founder replying in a thread

Based on this assessment, the primary messaging approach should be:

Validate, reframe, then show the mechanism. Name his symptoms in his own words so he feels seen ("it's not just me"). Then reframe the cause: it isn't the hours, the staff or the business model. He has built systems for everything except the man running it ("compounding money, depreciating yourself"). Next, show the mechanism (ten rules written on day 1, one lesson a day, a nine-line scorecard). Show the offer (the $9 bet) **only** to men who have already seen the reframe.

CURRENT ADS

All 13 ads open at problem aware and close at most aware within the same ad. No ad is dedicated to the reframe (for the solution-aware man) or to the offer (for retargeting). The ad Meta delivers most, the full 25-minute sales video, is a most-aware asset served to cold, problem-aware audiences.

SECTION 2

Emotional Drivers Analysis

Which core human needs does Project 1% address? Selections are based on what these men say in public forums, not on what the ads currently say.

Maslow's Hierarchy

- ○ Physiological (basic survival needs)
  Pain and sleep show up, but they aren't why he buys.
- ◐ Safety (security, stability, protection) **SECONDARY**
  Protecting what he built: his body, his family, "losing half the business in a divorce".
- ● Belonging (connection, relationships, community) **PRIMARY**
  "Every other man I know has a 9–5, so there's nobody I can really ask." Presence at home. A brotherhood.
- ● Esteem (recognition, status, respect, achievement) **PRIMARY**
  Self-respect and respect at home: "I'm always the problem solver, not the problem bringer."
- ◐ Self-actualization (growth, creativity, purpose) **SECONDARY**
  The lost drive: "that drive/spark is gone", "I'm in a fog". Who he becomes next.

Life-Force 8 Drives

- ◐ Survival, enjoyment of life, life extension **SECONDARY**
  A body that still works at 60. Actually enjoying what he paid for.
- ○ Enjoyment of food and beverages
- ● Freedom from fear, pain and danger **PRIMARY**
  The back, the burnout, the marriage going quiet, the fear of losing it all.
- ○ Sexual companionship
  Present underneath (desirability, testosterone), but never lead with it.
- ○ Comfortable living conditions
  He already has them. That's the point.
- ◐ To be superior; winning **SECONDARY**
  He still wants to win. Reframe it as winning without paying the hidden bill.
- ● Care and protection of loved ones **PRIMARY**
  "Our baby is never going to be a baby again." Present for his wife and kids.
- ◐ Social approval **SECONDARY**
  The respect of his wife, his kids and his peers. The man they copy.

The primary emotional transformation Project 1% delivers:

FROM

Successful on paper, empty and alone with it. Never off. Never fully home. Carrying every decision himself while his body sends the bill.

→

TO

Still building, but whole. Present at home, strong in his body, clear in his head, and no longer alone with it.

CURRENT ADS

The lead driver today is status and comfort objects: the Porsche, the Rolex, the penthouse, "the 1%", "an elite body". That pulls on *To be superior* and *Comfortable living*, which this man already has. *Care of loved ones* appears as one line ("make it home for dinner"). *Belonging* is a phrase ("a private brotherhood") that's never shown. Richard's injuries are used as credentials, not as the viewer's own fear.

SECTION 2 · CONTINUED

The emotions, in his words

★ marks the primary emotions to build creative around. Each line is grounded in a public post from a business owner or high earner.

Project 1% helps him avoid feeling:

Emotion	In his words
★ **Emptiness**	"Being in a 4* hotel swimming in the pool and feeling empty."
★ **Isolation**	"It's just me, staring at a laptop... really hard for outsiders to understand."
★ **Guilt toward family**	"Our baby is never going to be a baby again."
★ **Fear of the break**	"My body/mind is having a harder time coping."
Exhaustion	"Feeling deeply burnt out."
Fog, lost drive	"This time I'm in a fog. I don't have the drive."
Being trapped	"My business is like a child and constantly needs undivided attention."
Pride that blocks help	"I'm always the problem solver, not the problem bringer. It's hard to be vulnerable."
Irritability	"My threshold for lashing out is quite low."
Guilt about stopping	"I felt guilty for not taking action."

Project 1% helps him feel:

Emotion	What it looks like
★ **Present**	Home for dinner, and actually there. Phone face down.
★ **At peace**	"The work stopped following me home." Chest not tight on waking.
★ **Proud**	Self-respect earned by keeping his own word, not by his bank balance
★ **Not alone**	"Looking for like-minded people to hang with." A room of builders.
Clear and in control	Decisions made in advance, not argued at 6am
Strong	A body that works, training without paying for it
Driven again	The spark back, pointed at more than one number
Free	"Enough" as a decision, not a defeat

What Project 1% does <u>not</u> fix (keep it out of the copy)

- Business volatility: slow months, competitors, theft, a hacked website
- Clinical depression or anxiety. These need a professional.
- Grief
- Staffing and operations problems
- A marriage that needs couples therapy
- The discomfort of change itself. 35 days of keeping your word is hard. Say so.

RECOMMENDATION

Build creative around the four ★ pairs: **emptiness → present**, **isolation → not alone**, **guilt toward family → present at home**, **fear of the break → strong**. For a brand built on honesty, naming what it doesn't fix earns trust rather than costing sales.

SECTION 3

Persuasion Principles Selection

Pick 2–3 primary principles to lead the creative, and use the rest only in support. The current ads use seven or more in a single ad.

Pratfall effect PRIMARY

Strategic vulnerability for credibility

How: lead with the scars before the wins. The discs at 31, the floor in 2025, the stepkids' games he went to without really being there. "I was the coach with the penthouse and no health."

Today: used, but undercut by the Porsche, Rolex and St Regis lines.

Unity PRIMARY

Creating tribal identity

How: "builders with something to lose": men who solve every problem except their own. A cohort that starts together, and a brotherhood earned by finishing.

Today: weak. "If you're a simp, don't click" pushes men out instead of bringing the right ones in.

Commitment PRIMARY

Small yeses leading to bigger ones

How: the $9 bet → write your ten rules on day 1 → 35 lessons → the finishers' brotherhood → the strategy call.

Today: the "I give my word" contract is at checkout (good), but the call is pushed *before* day 1, which breaks the ladder.

Supporting principles

Principle	How to use it	Today
Loss aversion SUPPORT	The cost of waiting, in his words: "the baby is never going to be a baby again". Worst case vs best case.	Only in the video's last minutes
Anchoring SUPPORT	One honest anchor: 1:1 with Richard costs $25k a year	Inflated: a $5,626 "value" and a price that steps down from $2,997
Authority SUPPORT	3,000+ clients and $10M+ through Property Consulting, a real property portfolio, real mentors. Use it *after* the vulnerability.	Overused: opens or anchors most ads
Social proof LATER	Stories from cohort 1, including what their partners noticed. Until then, borrow honestly from Property Consulting.	"Thousands of men in a growing movement" while the group has 11 members
Reciprocity SUPPORT	Give first: a free 7-day "write your code" email series, or the morning and evening routine. Then deliver it.	Promised in the video, never delivered
Liking SUPPORT	Council estate to Dubai, British, a stepdad, "not the biggest name"	Present, works well
Scarcity ONLY IF REAL	Only a genuine cohort start date	Changes at every step: "first 100", "September 1st", "limited time"

RECOMMENDATION

Lead with pratfall, unite with unity, convert with commitment. The order inside every ad matters: scars, then "men like us", then proof, then one small yes. Remove fake scarcity and inflated anchors entirely. For a man who distrusts gurus, one broken principle cancels the rest.

SECTION 4

Message Framing Matrix

One core message, framed five ways. Each frame suits a different man on a different day.

CORE MESSAGE

You've spent years compounding your money and depreciating yourself. Project 1% is the 35-day foundation for building the man first, from a builder who paid the full price for success and rebuilt.

Frame	Example for Project 1%	Best for	In the current ads?
Benefit	"Keep building, and come home with your back, your marriage and your peace intact."	Problem aware	Partly. "Make it home for dinner" (ads #3, #5, #7, #12) is good, but buried at second 12.
Pain avoidance	"It's not the hours you work. It's that you're never actually off." · "Don't wait for the slipped disc."	Problem aware	Yes, but as an insult ("a dumb idea... goofy challenges") rather than his pain.
Status / identity	"Builders maintain their assets. You're the one you've neglected." · "The real 1% didn't trade everything to get there."	Solution aware	Yes, but through objects (Porsche, Rolex). Swap to identity: builder, provider, the man his kids copy.
Process / mechanism	"Day 1, you write ten rules while your head is clear. Every day after, one lesson and one action. A nine-line scorecard replaces the single line called net worth."	Solution & product aware	Partly: the operating-system metaphor (#6) and the four pillars (#4, #10). The mechanism changes name from ad to ad.
Testimonial / story	"At 31 my back gave out. In 2025 I was on the floor of my apartment, business at its best, with no one to call." Later: member stories and what their partners noticed.	Product aware	Yes: Richard's own story (#9, #11). No customer stories yet.

CURRENT ADS

The ads *did* use several frames, which is good instinct. But each frame wasn't matched to an awareness stage, the mechanism has four different names, and every ad carries the same caption. So the test can't show which frame wins.

RECOMMENDATION

Give each frame its own ads, each with its own headline and caption. Then the numbers show which frame resonates (for example: pain avoidance vs identity), not just which video holds attention.

SECTION 5

Hook Development

New hooks built from the men's own language, matched to their awareness level.

FOR UNAWARE / PROBLEM AWARE

"It's not the hours you work. It's that you're never actually off."
From: "not the hours... I can't be present"

"You've fixed every problem in your business except the man running it."
Reframe

"Every other man you know has a 9–5. Nobody gets what this feels like."
From: "nobody I can really ask"

"Four-star hotel. Pool. Phone off. And you still feel nothing?"
From: "swimming in the pool and feeling empty"

"Always the problem solver. Never the problem bringer."
From a 40-year-old plumbing company owner

FOR SOLUTION / PRODUCT AWARE

"Hiring more people won't fix this. Neither will selling the business."
Against the operations fixes he's tried

"You don't need another 75-day challenge. You need ten rules you wrote while your head was clear."
Mechanism vs willpower

"Therapy talks about it. Hustle coaches shout over it. This is one decision a day for 35 days."
Positioning

"Most programs fix one pillar. This one fixes the man holding all four."
Builds on ad #9

FOR MOST AWARE

"$9. 35 days. Worst case, you lose a coffee."
The $9 bet

"Do all 35 days. If nothing changes, get your $9 back."
Completion guarantee

"You watched the video. Here's the $9 bet."
Retargeting

"The next cohort starts Monday. We start together."
Only with a real date

The current hooks, mapped

Current ads: no hook is written for the most-aware man, only one (#9) differentiates, and four ads share one hook.

Ad	Opening line	Awareness level	Verdict
Caption	"If you want a life that feels as good as a $200,000 Porsche 911 Turbo looks..."	Desire / status	Off strategy: sells the object
#1	"What you're about to hear... might make you angry... whispered in the back rooms"	Unaware / curiosity	Guru genre, off-promise
#2	"For ambitious men carrying real stress, real responsibility..."	Problem aware	Good callout
#3 #5 #7 #12	"Cutting family time out... is a dumb idea for men who want to build wealth."	Problem aware	One hook in 4 of 13 ads; calls him dumb
#4 #10	"This is specifically for men already winning on paper."	Problem aware	Precise callout
#6	"Most men upgrade the car, the income, the title. Never the operating system."	Unaware / reframe	Strongest reframe
#8	"If you're a man chasing more..."	Problem aware	Broad
#9	"Stop trying to fix one pillar of your life while ignoring the other three."	Solution aware	Differentiates
#11	"If I could go back 15 years, to when I was a 23-year-old medical device salesman..."	Problem aware / story	Strong story
#13	"If my goal was to stop feeling stuck and actually feel happy again..."	Problem aware	Generic wording

SECTION 6

Messaging Sequencing Plan

Four exposures that move him one awareness stage at a time, instead of one ad that tries to do all four.

Exposure	Awareness target	Key message	Emotional trigger	Call to action	Format
1st	Problem aware Cold, broad audience	Name the symptom in his words: "It's not the hours. It's that you're never actually off."	Recognition and relief: "it's not just me"	Watch Richard's story, or get the free 7-day code (soft)	Native note-style static; 30–60s Richard to camera
2nd	Problem → solution aware Engaged viewers, page visitors	The reframe: you've compounded your money and depreciated yourself. It isn't a workload problem.	Hope and curiosity	See how the 35 days work	Founder explainer; whiteboard or motion graphic of the Foundation
3rd	Product aware Page visitors, 50%+ viewers	Proof: Richard's rebuild (transformation photos), the stepdad story, the first members' voices	Trust and belonging	Try it for $9	Before-and-after static; member UGC; partner's-eye story
4th	Most aware Checkout abandoners, 75%+ viewers	The $9 bet: worst case vs best case, the completion guarantee, a real start date	Safety and real urgency	Start day 1 now	Offer static; short founder close

CURRENT ADS

Every ad runs all four steps in one video. The ad with the most delivery sends cold viewers straight to the step-4 asset, a 25-minute sales video. Nothing in the account is set up for exposures 2–4 to reach the men who engaged with exposure 1.

RECOMMENDATION

Run broad, with creative diversity across all four stages, so the algorithm finds each man the right message. Then make sure the 25-minute video and the $9 offer reach men who have already engaged, not strangers.

Repetition without fatigue

- **Same core message, different formats:** talking head, native static, whiteboard, member UGC.
- **Same core message, different words:** "never actually off" / "the business follows you home" / "you're there, but you're not there".
- **Refresh hooks and thumbnails before the message changes.** Keep the promise identical from ad to checkout.

SECTION 7

Creative Evaluation Checklist

The 10-point check, applied to the 13 live ads as a set. ✔ passes · ~ partly · ✖ fails.

Check	Today	Why
Does it clearly address the right awareness level?	~	The hooks are problem aware, but each ad then runs to the offer. Ad #1 (a bottom-funnel asset) is served cold.
Does it tap into at least one powerful emotional driver?	✔	Yes, but the lead driver is status objects, not the research drivers (loved ones, fear and pain, belonging).
Does it emphasize transformation, not just features?	~	#3, #9 and #11 sell transformation. #4, #6 and #10 drift into features (four pillars, 35 lessons, a nine-line scorecard).
Does it leverage 2–3 persuasion principles effectively?	✖	Seven or more are stacked per ad. Scarcity and anchoring are inconsistent, and the promised gift is never delivered.
Is the hook strong enough to stop the scroll?	~	"Most men upgrade the car..." and "winning on paper" are strong. "Dumb idea" is used four times. "Might make you angry" is guru genre.
Is the primary benefit immediately clear?	~	"Build a 1% life" is abstract. "Make it home for dinner" is clear but arrives at second 12.
Would I be excited to see it as the target customer?	~	Richard's to-camera stories, yes. The Porsche and Rolex lines and "simp", no.
Have I created pattern interrupts or distinctive elements?	✔	Good format variety: kinetic text, whiteboard, operating-system graphics, two-camera talking head.
Does it address objections the audience might have?	~	The guarantee is in every ad. "I'm too busy", "another guru" and "I've tried challenges" are only handled in the video's closing FAQ.
Is the call to action clear and compelling?	✖	The ad price differs from checkout. The "button below this video" doesn't exist in the feed. The "short video" is 25 minutes. The "page that breaks down all 35 lessons" doesn't.

Areas for improvement

1. **One price, one promise, from ad to checkout.** The $9 bet, with a completion guarantee.
2. **Split the creative by awareness stage** (section 6) instead of every ad doing everything.
3. **Rewrite the shared caption.** Drop the Porsche and Rolex. Lead with loved ones, freedom from pain, belonging.
4. **Lead with vulnerability, then authority.** Scars first, credentials second.
5. **Remove fake scarcity and inflated value.** Deliver the promised free gift.
6. **Give each ad its own headline and caption,** so tests measure the message, not just the video.
7. **Move the 25-minute video to retargeting.** Build 30–60 second entry ads for cold audiences.
8. **Make the page deliver what the ads promise:** curriculum, price, guarantee.

SECTION 8

Winning Creative Formulas

Four proven structures, each written out for Project 1% from Richard's true story and the men's own words.

Problem → Agitation → Solution

Problem	"You're never actually off. Even on holiday, the business is in your head."
Agitate	"Your kids get what's left. Your back sends the bill. And the only person you'd call about it is you."
Solution	"35 days. One lesson a day. Ten rules you write on day 1, so the decisions are made before the 6am argument starts."

Feature → Advantage → Benefit

Feature	One lesson a day, most of them shorter than your commute.
Advantage	It fits a calendar that's already full. Nothing to add, nothing to reschedule.
Benefit	You change without stepping away from the business you built.

Before → After → Bridge

Before	"Early 2025: business at its best, me on the floor of my apartment, no one to call."
After	"Training again. Back intact. In the room when it matters."
Bridge	"The 35 principles I rebuilt on. That's Project 1%."

Objection → Counter → Reframe

Objection	"I've tried challenges. They last six weeks."
Counter	"This isn't a test of willpower. It runs on rules you wrote while your head was clear."
Reframe	"You don't need more discipline. You need fewer decisions."

REMEMBER

Psychology is how we find the right man and say something true in his own words. It is never a license to invent scarcity, inflate value or promise what the program can't deliver. For a brand whose promise is honesty, that line **is** the strategy.

Next steps

1. **Fact sheet:** agree one version of every number in Richard's story, used everywhere.
2. **Fix the funnel** (price, page, gift, call disclosure) before increasing spend.
3. **Brief the first batch** of creative by awareness stage: native statics, Richard to camera, the transformation, then member UGC after cohort 1.
4. **Judge the tests** on finish rate, refunds and qualified calls, not cost per $9 sale alone.

MF MOHAMMED FILALI

Creative Strategist

Consumer psychology, positioning and creative strategy for founder-led brands. Built from research, not guesswork.